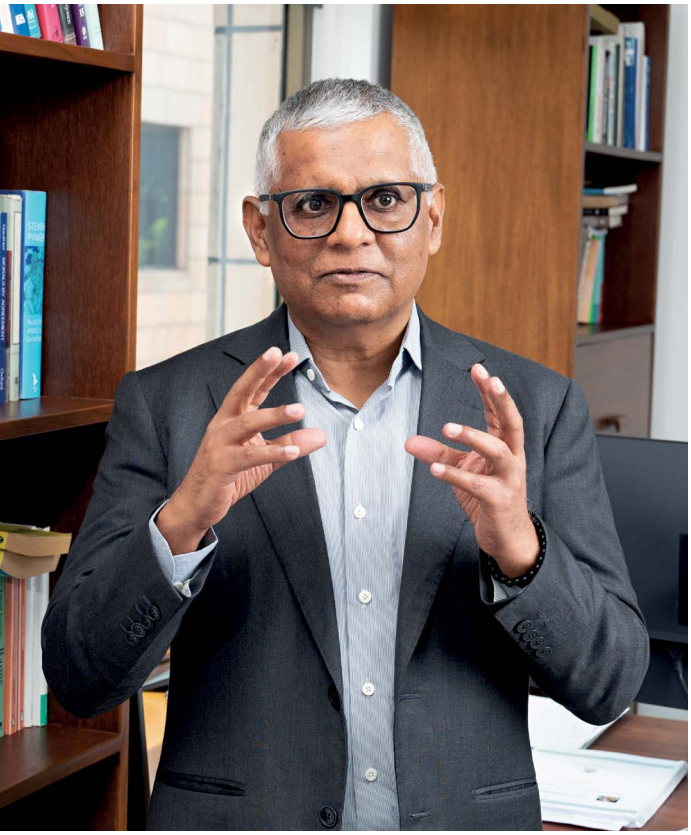




come in; they follow a structured curriculum, and then they move on. A more flexible learning model requires different ways of planning and organising.

Institutions will need to understand demand differently. They will need to know what people want to learn, when they want to learn it, and how those needs change over time.

This transition will not happen overnight. There will be experimentation and debate. But institutions need to be prepared because the environment around them is changing.

**Q: In an environment of constant change, how should managers prepare themselves to remain effective leaders?**

**A:** The biggest advantage a manager can have is the ability to keep learning. The pace of change means that knowledge becomes outdated faster than before. A successful manager will not be someone who believes they have all the answers. It will be someone who is willing to ask questions, challenge assumptions and adapt.

Leaders who remain curious are more likely to understand changing markets, new technologies and evolving customer needs. The future will belong to people who combine knowledge with judgement.

**Q: If you had to identify the biggest shift ahead, how do you see management education evolving over the coming years?**

**A:** The biggest shift is that education will become less about a single point in time and more about a continuous journey. The idea that someone completes education and then applies it for the rest of their career is becoming less realistic.

People will need opportunities to return, learn new skills and adapt as their roles change. That will require a different mindset from institutions. They will need to remain connected to industry, understand emerging needs and continuously update what they teach.

**Q: As India's economic influence grows, what does this mean for the future of management education in the country?**

**A:** The opportunity for India is not only economic growth. It is also the opportunity to develop ideas, frameworks and practices that emerge from the Indian experience. Many of the challenges that businesses face in India—operating at scale, serving diverse consumers, innovating under constraints—are challenges that many other economies will also face. The role of an institution like ISB is to study these experiences carefully and understand what lessons can be drawn from them. It is not enough to simply observe.

**Q: For students entering management education today, what should they keep in mind as they prepare for uncertain careers?**

**A:** Students should recognise that the value of education is not only in acquiring information. Information is increasingly available everywhere. The deeper value lies in learning how to think, analyse problems, and to work with people.

A successful career will require the ability to adapt repeatedly. The first job that someone takes after graduation may not define their entire career. They will have to learn new skills, move into new roles and understand new industries.

That is why curiosity becomes so important. People who remain open to learning will continue to create opportunities for themselves even as the environment changes. BT

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